

Marketing Plan

Wired Wednesday, Tools for Truth: Skills for Verifying Online Sources

Amanda M. Clark

Morgridge College of Education, University of Denver

LIS 4043: Advocacy & Marketing in LIS

Professor Ashley Brown

May 19, 2026

Introduction

The Georgetown Public Library (GPL), in Georgetown Texas, is a mid-size but very active library. Most of the marketing efforts at GPL are currently directed toward children's programming, teen programming, and adult arts and music programming. There is an ongoing program called Wired Wednesday for adults, but it is not marketed as widely as the arts and music programs. The following marketing plan will address the need to increase community exposure to a Wired Wednesday installation for older adults called 'Tools for Truth: Skills for Verifying Online Sources'. This course moves beyond the typical technology assistance program that is offered by inviting interested individuals to take place in a series of workshops that teach participants how to critically evaluate digital content, spot misinformation, and verify the authenticity of online sources of information. Key skills include lateral reading, using reverse image searches, checking factual claims, and identifying AI generated materials.

Goals and Objectives

The following goals are ambitious given the draw of previous adult programs but are also achievable given the size of the library and the inexpensive nature of the program. GPL hopes to:

- Generate a minimum of 30 attendee registrations
- Reach an attendance rate of 75% or higher
- Produce at least 150 patron and/or non-patron engagements (including likes, clicks, shares, comments, reference desk questions, requests for similar content, etc.)
- Increase community awareness of this series and other digital literacy services GPL offers for adults
- Boost repeat participation in Wired Wednesday programs and services

SWOT Analysis

In analyzing the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats that enacting this marketing plan will involve, the following considerations have been identified:

- Strengths: Loyal patron base, expanding local population, active Friends of the Library group, good reputation of offering relevant workshops to patron base
- Weaknesses: Limited budget of \$200, allocation of one staff member to run program
- Opportunities: Growing demand for digital literacy programming, steady stream of adult patrons, requests for free online resources, diversity of digital skill level in community
- Threats: Low awareness of civic online reasoning as a concept, increasing amount of online misinformation, adult population may not feel they need this skill or may feel intimidated by the subject matter

Overall, these factors suggest that the library is well-positioned to meet a growing community need.

However, the success of this marketing effort will depend on effective outreach and the careful use of limited resources.

Target Audience

The 'Wired Wednesday, Tools for Truth: Skills for Verifying Online Sources' series will primarily be marketed to the older adults in the Georgetown community. Individuals aged 55+ will be the target audience but instead of focusing on their age, marketing materials will focus on their motivations and their interests. For instance, various promotional items may ask community members if they regularly consume information online, if they'd like to know more about how to verify online sources of information, and if they want to become digital detectives. It may be a little cheesy, but it is also disarming for individuals who may be intimidated by a skill set they do not yet possess. Many digital literacies are general skills that can benefit lifelong learners, voters, avid consumers of news, parents

supporting teens and young adults, older adults looking for online safety tips, digital skills enthusiasts, or anyone else who uses the internet.

Venue

The Wired Wednesday series takes place in the second-floor meeting room at GPL from 4-5pm on Wednesdays. The 'Tools for Truth: Skills for Verifying Online Sources' series will be held here weekly.

Mission Analysis

GPL's mission and vision are to "engage, enlighten, and empower" and to be a catalyst for an enriched community, respectively (Georgetown Public Library, 2026). Digital literacy programming for older adults is consistent with the library's vision and strongly supports the mission by giving patrons the tools they need to participate more fully in a technology driven society. Moreover, research on the well-being of older adults has found that digital literacy programming and activities that take place in group settings can contribute to promoting a better quality of life (Silva et al., 2026).

The critical evaluation of online information is key to navigating the digital age safely and older adults should not be left behind in this endeavor. Contributing to an informed population is a core component of library values and reducing the amount of misinformation being ingested and circulated can benefit the library and the community at large. The marketing efforts outlined herein highlight to the GPL community that rather than simply providing access to information, GPL aims to empower patrons with the knowledge and skills they need to interpret and evaluate online sources of information on their own. Therefore, the marketing materials will reflect this theme of active intellectual independence.

Tactics

GPL has maintained a partnership with AARP for several years, providing information to patrons and hosting presentations on topics such as Social Security, Medicare, financial planning, and tax assistance. This partnership has set the stage for expanded programming that supports older adults in the GPL community. Tools for Truth is a natural extension of this partnership because this course is in direct alignment with AARP's interest in supporting older adults with fraud prevention tips and tools. AARP's logo will be incorporated into the marketing materials for this program because AARP is a trusted brand whose presence in marketing materials will help to attract attendees.

There will be a stack of mini-flyers at all reference desks, large poster-sized flyers will be posted on library bulletin boards, and reference staff will be asked and reminded to incorporate this event into their conversations with patrons. This course will be advertised on the GPL website's main page and the events calendar. GPL maintains four social media channels and therefore, social media advertisements will be posted on Instagram, Facebook, Pinterest, and Tumblr according to the timeline below. GPL's newsletter is released on a weekly basis and the newsletter advertisement for this course will be released in each of the seven newsletters that precede the event. In addition to this in-library marketing, time has been set aside during Week 3 in the timeline for community outreach. Flyers will be distributed at coffee and clothing shops, grocery stores, and other retail spaces throughout the downtown core. Outreach will also occur at Friends of the Georgetown Library events, the weekly farmer's market booth, senior centers, the parks and recreation building, local retirement communities, and health facilities.

Timeline

The following timeline is designed to accomplish the specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound goals mentioned earlier in this plan.

Week 1: Finalize Plans

- Share finalized program details with AARP representative
- Design marketing materials that include the AARP logo (a poster and digital social media graphics)
- Write a few social media captions to be used throughout the following 8 weeks
- Write a short description for the newsletter text
- Confirm registration page is active
- Create a checklist for the remaining portion of the timeline

Week 2: Library Visibility

- Print flyers and post them on library bulletin boards
- Add events to library website and library calendar
- Begin posting social media announcements
- Mention series in library newsletter
- Ask reference and service staff to start mentioning the event to patrons and handing out mini-flyers

Week 3: Community Visibility

- Distribute flyers to community partners at:
 - Senior Centers
 - Farmer's Market
 - Recreation Centers
 - Retirement Communities
 - Health Facilities

Week 4: Repeat

- Second set of social media posts
- Ask library staff to mention series at other programs
- Remind community members to register before program is full
- Monitor registrations

Week 5: Recruit

- Second newsletter post
- If registration is low, reach out personally to community contacts
- Ask Friends group to advertise program to other likely participants

Week 6: Push

- Consider using a portion of the \$200 budget to pay for an advertising push on social media
- Continue to promote at reference desks, on social media, and with community partners

Week 7: Remind

- Send reminder emails to registrants
- Third social media post that involves a reminder of the program starting one week from now
- Prepare in-class materials

Week 8: Finalize Event

- Final reminders to participants
- Final social post on the day before the program starts
- Print attendance materials
- Gather participant feedback, ask patrons to share their experiences online

Budget

With a modest budget of \$200, GPL will be able to use a professional print shop for flyers and will reserve the remaining funds for a social media advertising push that is audience specific and geographically targets likely participants.

Accomplishing the Work

To market this program successfully, the existing communication systems in place at GPL will be leveraged. The library already utilizes the Emma Email software platform to distribute its weekly newsletter. This software comes with mobile-optimized design templates that are easy to tailor to this program. It can also be used to preload announcements and schedule them to be sent at specific dates and times. All of the messaging materials will be created well before they are needed and will be stored in a content calendar spreadsheet. The spreadsheet will have a separate column for each content channel and will contain links to the pre-built content. This will make for easy posting as the countdown to the program progresses. In addition to the technological and planning aspects of accomplishing this work, time has also been set aside in the timeline above for in-person outreach activities outside of the library. These outreach activities will also be laid out in a spreadsheet and will be reflected in the work calendar so that management is aware of any “off-campus” activity.

Assessment Techniques and Adjustments

If the marketing strategies above are not proving effective, there are quantitative and qualitative values to consider before pivoting. If there are not enough early registrants to hold the class, the sense of urgency in the messaging can be turned up. For example, reminders to potential attendees that spots are limited can be added. However, being careful not to focus solely on social media adjustments may be important here because this course is targeting older adults who may not rely on social media as much as a younger audience might. Therefore, if there is not a lot of active engagement

with virtual efforts, pivoting to an increase in the amount of in-person marketing at social events in the community may be necessary. Additionally, if people are not registering online but are only registering in-person, then marketing materials can be adjusted to better reflect the more popular registration option.

On a more positive note, if the course description appeals to a younger audience and social media marketing results in requests for similar programming, then another adjustment would be to discuss this finding with library management and consider adding more courses in this same vein for other audiences. Regardless of the popularity of the course, casual conversations with patrons about the quality of the marketing materials may provide some insights. Asking folks if this description is appealing, if they are likely to participate, what they find intriguing or not about the opportunity, what their impression of the goal of the course is, and so on might reveal some marketing insights.

Flyer or Social Media Sample

Please see flyer below. It was purposefully designed with a dark/light contrast as the aging eye naturally loses contrast sensitivity and a lot of bright colors may be perceived as chaos. It is also fun that the colors are giving a Sherlock Holmes-style digital detective vibe.

Georgetown Public Library presents:

TOOLS FOR TRUTH

A FREE WIRED WEDNESDAY COURSE! LEARN HOW TO:

- ✓ **VERIFY ONLINE SOURCES**
- ✓ **SPOT MISINFORMATION**
- ✓ **IDENTIFY AI GENERATED MATERIALS**

In partnership with:

AARP[®]



Wednesday

JUNE, 8 2026

Second Floor Meeting Room

RSVP today at: <http://bit.ly/toolsfortruth>



(512) 930-3551



@gtpubliclibrary

References

Georgetown Public Library. (2026). *Policy, Vision, and Mission*. City of Georgetown, Texas.

https://georgetowntexas.gov/library/about/policy_vision_and_mission.php

Silva, S., Pocinho, R., Gordo, S., & Fernández Muñoz, J. J. (2026). Effectiveness of a treatment in older adults on physical frailty, anxiety, and depression: A longitudinal study including workshops on cognitive stimulation, creative arts, digital literacy, and physical-motor activity. *Clinical Gerontologist*, 49(1), 47–54. <https://doi-org.du.idm.oclc.org/10.1080/07317115.2025.2494636>